The Lemonade Stand

By Bryan P. Harnetiaux

INTRODUCTION

MAN: Those who have
WOMAN: and those who have not.
MAN: Those who want
WOMAN: and those who want not.
BOTH: Those who give
MAN: out of wealth.
WOMAN: and out of poverty.
MAN: "Lemonade Stand"
WOMAN: By Bryan P. Harnetiaux

MAN: **(Pg 53-60)** *(He enters preoccupied with a piece of paper and then discovers the lemonade stand.)* Hello. *(The WOMAN, sitting behind the stand, smiles.)* Hot today, a scorcher.

WOMAN: Yes. It is.

MAN: Unseasonably hot. *(Explaining)* Unusual for this time of year.

WOMAN: You're right, there. It'll go, sooner or later.

MAN: Yeah. Say, would you know where Oliveras Street is? *(Handing her piece of paper)* What, twenty one hundred block... There's a house for sale tomorrow; and I wanted to take a look at the property.

WOMAN: No.

MAN: It can't be far. Just a general direction would help.

WOMAN: *(Indicates vaguely.)* Somewhere over that way. I don't know. Why do you want that property; property like that?

MAN: What?

WOMAN: You wanna buy property around here?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

MAN: Yes.

WOMAN: Why?

MAN: Why not? Investment. You gotta find it; it rarely finds you.

WOMAN: Bad investment around here. I wouldn't.

MAN: You wouldn't?

WOMAN: Maybe somebody's trying to take you.

MAN: Maybe. I'll keep an eye out.

WOMAN: Who's selling? The property. Maybe I know them.

MAN: A bank. It's a foreclosure.

WOMAN: Oh.

MAN: Business. What makes the world go round. Selling lemonade, huh?

WOMAN: Yes.

MAN: One of those things that just sells itself.

WOMAN: Yes, it does.

MAN: Boy takes me back. *(Wiping face with handkerchief)* Benny LaRuso and me. Our secret was mobility. Had our stand built right on top of my Red Rider wagon. We'd cover forty blocks on a hot afternoon. Long time ago. Well, is it any good?

WOMAN: I think so.

MAN: It's the stuff to have when it's thirsty out, that's for sure. This your regular corner?

WOMAN: No. I don't have a regular corner.

MAN: S ome say you need a regular corner to build up clientele, customers. Not necessary. We did just fine. It's the product that counts - and somebody with a need. Gotta have that. You move around, then?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

WOMAN: Huh?

MAN: To different locations. You move around?

WOMAN: I did this today. Just today.

MAN: Trying to get movie money, huh?

WOMAN: Yeah. Movie money.

MAN: A little slow today.

WOMAN: It's been pretty busy. Slow right now. *(Looking in pitcher)* I've only got about one glass left.

MAN: That's good. Very good. *(Takes out coin purse.)* Well, why don't I take the last glass? Then you'll have it licked.

WOMAN: If you want.

MAN: If I want? *(Chuckles.)* It'd be kinda fun. It's been a while I since I had any. How much?

WOMAN: Seven thousand.

MAN: *(Fishing for change)* Pardon?

WOMAN: Seven thousand dollars.

MAN: *(Has a good laugh; WOMAN joins in.)* No. Really... *(Succumbs to laughter again.)* That's good. In business, you get the customer laughing, you get the business. So, what's it go for these days?

WOMAN: This goes for seven thousand.

MAN: That's ridiculous. Nobody in their right mind is going to pay seven thousand for a glass of lemonade.

WOMAN: Maybe. It's my lemonade.

MAN: *(Laughing again, although with a different quality, as he starts to leave)* Seven thousand ... *(Coming back)* Are you trying to make a fool

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

out of me? Seven thousand! *(Picks up a jar of pennies and shakes it.)* What are these?!

WOMAN: They're pennies.

MAN: I know they're pennies! You got them selling lemonade.

WOMAN: Those were other glasses and other people. You are you, and this is my last glass.

MAN: Ah, you admit you sold it for pennies.

WOMAN: That's all they had.

MAN: So that's it. You see me as some mark who'd pay seven thousand dollars for a lousy glass of lemonade.

WOMAN: It's not lousy. It's exceptional lemonade. This is all that's left. If you want it, buy it.

MAN: For seven thousand dollars. I could buy a house in this neighborhood for that. A carload of lemons wouldn't cost that much. What am I doing here? You're not serious; you can't be serious... *(He laughs.)* Alright, I'll give you a buck for it - for entertainment value. *(Hands her a dollar. She does not take it. Instead she tears a blank sheet of paper out of an old notebook - or perhaps some excess butcher paper off the corner of the stand and hands it to the man.)* What's this?

WOMAN: An application.

MAN: What application? It's a blank piece of paper.

WOMAN: Just put all you own on the left side and all you owe on the right. Add it up and turn it in here.

MAN: You want a net worth statement?

WOMAN: If you don't wanna pay my price, you have ta fill it out.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

MAN: Why?

WOMAN: To see if you qualify - for the lower price.

MAN: Which is?

WOMAN: Three cents.

MAN: I offered you a dollar.

WOMAN: My price isn't a dollar. It's seven thousand, unless you qualify.

MAN: I have no intention of qualifying, and I am not paying seven thousand.

WOMAN: Good-bye.

MAN: *(Starts to say something, but stops.)* Good-bye. *(Starts to leave.)*

WOMAN: Could I have my form back?

MAN: *(Returning)* Yes, you can have your form back! *(Shoves it at her.)* What is so special about this lemonade?!

WOMAN: It's my last glass.

MAN: You can make more.

WOMAN: Not like this. There's no more like this.

MAN: You said that. That doesn't tell me anything. What it tastes like, what it's made of, why you wanna charge me seven thousand dollars for it? You want me to spend that kind of money, I don't even know what it tastes like. *(WOMAN ladles out a small amount of lemonade and hands MAN the stirring spoon.)* What's this cost?

WOMAN: Nothing. *(MAN drinks the sample.)*

MAN: My God. That's good. That's quite good. Where'd you get this stuff?

WOMAN: I made it myself, from scratch. I told you it was I exceptional.

MAN: Real lemons, right? Big as footballs. Benny and I got ours from the corner market. Big as footballs. He was fun, but couldn't sell anything

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

to save his life. He pulled the wagon, I sold the lemonade. Nice guy, kid. There's something else in this. What is it?

WOMAN: You wanna buy it or not?

MAN: Not at your price. Hey, I'm trying to be fair. I don't have to be here at all.

WOMAN: You were lost and thirsty as I remember. It had nothing to do with bein' fair.

MAN: Where do you get off talking to a customer that way. I'm not robbing you. *(Going to his wallet, he sets ten dollars on the counter.)* I'll give you ten dollars, that's it. *(WOMAN shakes her head.)* You need it and you know it.

WOMAN: I close in a couple of minutes.

MAN: *I want that lemonade!*

WOMAN: That's my price.

MAN: S uch principles. You can't eat principles. You can't sleep under principles. You can't keep warm with principles. *(Once again to his wallet, peels off cash and sets it on the counter.)* One hundred dollars. I don't know why I'm doing it, but there it is. Go ahead. When's the last time you saw a hundred dollars for a glass of lemonade? When's the last time you saw a hundred dollars? Go on, pick it up. *(WOMAN stares at the bills. Slowly, a drool of spit drops from her lips onto the money.)* Why you... worthless piece of ... garbage. I tried to help you.

WOMAN: On your terms. At your convenience. For your entertainment. You tried nothing. Nothing.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

MAN: Seven-thousand-dollar lemonade. I'm talking to a nut. What looney farm did you escape from? The world doesn't work this way! *(During the following, MAN kicks at one of the corners of the lemonade stand for emphasis and it collapses. Seeing this, he is at first startled but then continues to lay it to ruins. During this, WOMAN grabs the pitcher and clutches it.)* You don't set up some flimsy stand and ask for the sky. Nobody owes nobody the sky. And you haven't the decency to go crazy somewhere else, away from those of us who are trying like hell to be reasonable! *(He stops; the stand is in shambles.)* Didn't mean to ...

WOMAN: Yes, I know...

MAN: Take this. For the stand. *(He goes to hand her the money. She does not take it, so he sets it down and starts to go.)* I'm sorry. *(Pause)* You ask too much.

WOMAN: You give too little.

MAN: What was in the lemonade?

WOMAN: Tears. *(MAN exits as he came. WOMAN then exits in direction of Oliveras Street.)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Bryan P. Harnetiaux
Book: More One-Act Plays for Acting Students, Pg 53-60
ISBN: 978-1566080873
Publisher: Meriwether Publishing
Date (Month/Year): July 2003

AWARD HISTORY

KS State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY